

Back Up Data by Using a Simple Shell Script



Though there are a number of database backup tools available in the computer app market, this article is targeted at systems administrators who might not like to get their hands dirty with the complex configuration process involved. For them, we present a simple shell script that will perform the task adequately, with no complications.

This article presents a basic backup shell script that will take a backup of the desired database along with the document root of your website. The script will run via system cron/systemd timers on a pre-defined time and save the backup to a specified directory. Backups will be kept for five days (by default) on the system, after which they will be deleted automatically to save disk space. The script is customisable according to end user needs.

For systems administrators like me, data backups are vital so as to ensure that data is readily available if anything goes wrong. Data can become corrupt due to many reasons, including a disk crash, power failures, an improper shutdown or restart of the server, incorrectly saved data which leads to a hard restart, and the list goes on. In any scenario, if there is a backup available, systems administrators can restore data without getting into the hassle of recovering it from the damaged disk itself.

So here is the simple shell script you could use for backing up your data:

```
#!/usr/bin/env bash
#
# Date: 27 January, 2015
# Author: Aman Hanjrah
# URI: http://techlinux.net and http://phpmysql.com
# License: GNU GPL v2.0
# Description: The script is used for performing database
and document root backup and place it inside a pre-defined
```

```
directory defined in one of the variables.
#
# Start
function main() {
    init
    chkBackupDir
}

function init() {
    BACKUP_DIR="/path/to/backup/directory"
    DB_USER="db_user"
    DB_PASSWORD="db_password"
    DB_NAME="db_name"
    DOC_ROOT="/path/to/document/root"
    DAYS_TO_KEEP_BACKUP="5"
}

function chkBackupDir() {
    if [[ ! -d "$BACKUP_DIR" ]]; then
        mkdir "$BACKUP_DIR"
    fi
    backupDocRoot
}

function backupDocRoot() {
    'which tar' -cjf "$BACKUP_DIR/doc_root_backup-${date
+%d-%m-%y}.tar.bz2 --directory="$DOC_ROOT" .
```